

SUPERVISED VOCATIONAL QUALIFICATION DIPLOMA - EXAMINATION

Session: Revision Mock Set 03	Duration: 3 hours
Specialty: Psychotherapy	Coefficient: 04
Eliminatory mark: < 8/20	Training reference: VTI-AEDA examination style

COMPREHENSIVE VOCATIONAL PAPER PRACTICE SET 03

Revision material based on the supplied VTI-AEDA 2025 examination format and the supplied psychotherapy course recordings. Not an official examination paper.

PART ONE: PSYCHOPATHOLOGY

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions: Place a bold tick against the appropriate response option provided. (10mks)

1. A therapist notes that Kemi has perfectionism, orderliness, rigidity and control that interfere with flexibility and task completion. Which condition should be considered first from the options below?
 - A. Substance use disorder
 - B. Schizoid personality disorder
 - C. Obsessive-compulsive personality disorder (OCPD)
 - D. Major depressive disorder
2. A therapist notes that Lucas has detachment from social relationships and restricted emotional expression with little desire for close relationships. Which condition should be considered first from the options below?
 - A. Generalized anxiety disorder (GAD)
 - B. Substance use disorder
 - C. Schizophrenia
 - D. Schizoid personality disorder
3. Hassan, a 34-year-old sales representative, presents with excessive need to be cared for, difficulty making decisions independently, submissiveness and fear of separation. Which diagnosis or clinical concept best fits this presentation?
 - A. Bipolar disorder
 - B. Agoraphobia
 - C. Dependent personality disorder
 - D. Opioid intoxication
4. Owen, a 27-year-old nurse, presents with persistent social-communication difficulties together with restricted or repetitive patterns of behavior or interests beginning in development. Which diagnosis or clinical concept best fits this presentation?
 - A. Anorexia nervosa, binge-eating/purging type
 - B. Panic disorder
 - C. Autism spectrum disorder
 - D. Schizophrenia
5. Carlos, a 37-year-old driver, presents with recurrent unexpected panic attacks followed by persistent worry about more attacks or maladaptive avoidance. Which diagnosis or clinical concept best fits this presentation?
 - A. Schizophrenia
 - B. Post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD)
 - C. Generalized anxiety disorder (GAD)
 - D. Panic disorder
6. During assessment, Xavier reports excessive, difficult-to-control worry across several life areas for about six months, with tension, restlessness or poor sleep. Which of the following is the BEST match?

- A. Schizoid personality disorder
 - B. Substance use disorder
 - C. Binge-eating disorder
 - D. Generalized anxiety disorder (GAD)
7. Esther, a 53-year-old civil servant, presents with marked fear of a specific object or situation that triggers immediate anxiety and avoidance out of proportion to the actual danger. Which diagnosis or clinical concept best fits this presentation?
- A. Anorexia nervosa, binge-eating/purging type
 - B. Substance use disorder
 - C. Bulimia nervosa
 - D. Specific phobia
8. During assessment, Irene reports marked fear of social or performance situations because of possible scrutiny, embarrassment or negative evaluation. Which of the following is the BEST match?
- A. Schizophrenia
 - B. Major depressive disorder
 - C. Bipolar disorder
 - D. Social anxiety disorder
9. A therapist notes that Owen has fear and avoidance of situations where escape may be difficult or help unavailable, such as crowds, public transport or being outside alone. Which condition should be considered first from the options below?
- A. Binge-eating disorder
 - B. Anorexia nervosa, binge-eating/purging type
 - C. Agoraphobia
 - D. Substance use disorder
10. During assessment, Esther reports intrusive unwanted thoughts or urges and/or repetitive behaviors or mental acts performed to reduce anxiety. Which of the following is the BEST match?
- A. Post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD)
 - B. Obsessive-compulsive disorder (OCD)
 - C. Obsessive-compulsive personality disorder (OCPD)
 - D. Specific phobia

SECTION B: ANSWER TRUE OR FALSE (5mks)

- 1. Schizoid personality disorder is defined primarily by intense fear of criticism and rejection. TRUE / FALSE
- 2. Autism spectrum disorder includes both social-communication difficulties and restricted/repetitive behavior patterns. TRUE / FALSE
- 3. The four D framework can include deviance, distress, dysfunction and danger. TRUE / FALSE
- 4. Comorbidity means that two or more disorders can occur in the same person. TRUE / FALSE
- 5. A specific phobia is generalized worry across many areas of life. TRUE / FALSE

SECTION C: SHORT ESSAY (10mks)

- 1. Differentiate OCD from obsessive-compulsive personality disorder. (2mks)
- 2. Give two signs that suggest psychosis. (2mks)
- 3. Why must suicide risk be assessed in a severely depressed client? (2mks)
- 4. State two differences between GAD and a specific phobia. (2mks)
- 5. What does DSM refer to in psychopathology? (2mks)

PART TWO: THEORIES/TECHNIQUES IN PSYCHOTHERAPY

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions: Place a bold tick against the appropriate response option provided. (15mks)

1. In a session with Carlos, the counselor emphasizes the therapist explains or offers meaning about patterns, defenses, dreams, resistance or behavior. This BEST illustrates:
 - A. Flooding
 - B. Systematic desensitization
 - C. Operant conditioning
 - D. Interpretation
2. In a session with Wendy, the counselor emphasizes the client unconsciously avoids material or processes that threaten to bring unacceptable conflict into awareness. This BEST illustrates:
 - A. Rational Emotive Behavior Therapy (REBT)
 - B. Free association
 - C. Exposure therapy
 - D. Resistance
3. A therapist working with Uma uses an intervention characterized by the client redirects feelings, expectations or relationship patterns from important past relationships onto the therapist. Which approach or technique is being used?
 - A. Systematic desensitization
 - B. Negative reinforcement
 - C. Cognitive behavioral therapy (CBT)
 - D. Transference
4. A therapist working with Brenda uses an intervention characterized by the therapist's emotional reactions to a client, especially reactions influenced by the therapist's own history or unresolved issues. Which approach or technique is being used?
 - A. Gestalt therapy
 - B. Countertransference
 - C. Person-centered therapy
 - D. Negative reinforcement
5. A therapist working with Victor uses an intervention characterized by therapy emphasizing unconscious conflict, early relationships, defenses, transference, resistance and insight. Which approach or technique is being used?
 - A. Psychoanalytic therapy
 - B. Rational Emotive Behavior Therapy (REBT)
 - C. Systematic desensitization
 - D. Classical conditioning
6. In a session with Kemi, the counselor emphasizes a goal-directed, socially embedded approach emphasizing conscious choice, responsibility, lifestyle and movement from inferiority toward useful belonging. This BEST illustrates:
 - A. Adlerian therapy
 - B. Systematic desensitization
 - C. Progressive muscle relaxation
 - D. Gestalt therapy
7. In a session with Patricia, the counselor emphasizes a non-directive relationship based on accurate empathy, unconditional positive regard and congruence. This BEST illustrates:
 - A. Interpretation
 - B. Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT)
 - C. Person-centered therapy
 - D. Retroflexion

- 8.** In a session with Uma, the counselor emphasizes a structured approach linking thoughts, emotions and behaviors and using cognitive and behavioral change strategies. This BEST illustrates:
- A. Cognitive behavioral therapy (CBT)
 - B. Social skills training
 - C. Free association
 - D. Operant conditioning
- 9.** Which psychotherapy concept is most accurately described by the following: identifying inaccurate or dysfunctional thoughts, examining evidence and developing more balanced alternatives?
- A. Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT)
 - B. Extinction
 - C. Cognitive restructuring
 - D. Retroflexion
- 10.** In a session with Victor, the counselor emphasizes Albert Ellis' approach that identifies irrational beliefs between events and emotional consequences and actively disputes those beliefs. This BEST illustrates:
- A. Rational Emotive Behavior Therapy (REBT)
 - B. Existential therapy
 - C. Cognitive restructuring
 - D. Systematic desensitization
- 11.** A therapist working with Victor uses an intervention characterized by an REBT imagery exercise in which the client vividly imagines a difficult event, experiences the emotion, then practices changing unhealthy emotion by changing beliefs. Which approach or technique is being used?
- A. Rational emotive imagery
 - B. Person-centered therapy
 - C. Psychoanalytic therapy
 - D. Exposure therapy
- 12.** In a session with Xavier, the counselor emphasizes a here-and-now experiential approach emphasizing awareness, contact, unfinished business and integration. This BEST illustrates:
- A. Gestalt dream work
 - B. Adlerian therapy
 - C. Gestalt therapy
 - D. Cognitive restructuring
- 13.** Which psychotherapy concept is most accurately described by the following: the client speaks to an imagined person or part of self placed in an empty chair, often switching roles to deepen awareness?
- A. Empty-chair technique
 - B. Flooding
 - C. Free association
 - D. In vivo exposure
- 14.** Which psychotherapy concept is most accurately described by the following: the client re-enacts a dream in the present and may speak as different people, objects or elements of the dream?
- A. Classical conditioning
 - B. Adlerian therapy
 - C. Rational Emotive Behavior Therapy (REBT)
 - D. Gestalt dream work
- 15.** A therapist working with Brenda uses an intervention characterized by turning back onto oneself what one wants to do to another, or doing to oneself what one wishes another would do. Which approach or technique is being used?
- A. Cognitive behavioral therapy (CBT)

- B. Classical conditioning
- C. Retroflexion
- D. Gestalt therapy

SECTION B: ANSWER TRUE OR FALSE (5mks)

1. The empty-chair technique is commonly associated with Gestalt therapy. TRUE / FALSE
2. Existential therapy aims to eliminate every form of anxiety from life. TRUE / FALSE
3. Adlerian therapy emphasizes purposeful, goal-directed behavior and personal responsibility. TRUE / FALSE
4. CBT assumes thoughts, emotions and behaviors can influence one another. TRUE / FALSE
5. DBT teaches mindfulness, distress tolerance, emotion regulation and interpersonal effectiveness. TRUE / FALSE

SECTION C: SHORT ESSAY (5mks)

1. What is transference? (2mks)
2. What is countertransference? (2mks)
3. State one goal of existential therapy. (1mks)

PART THREE: PROFESSIONAL ORIENTATION AND ETHICAL/LEGAL ISSUES IN PSYCHOTHERAPY

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions: Place a bold tick against the appropriate response option provided. (15mks)

1. A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by keeping commitments, maintaining trust and being faithful to professional responsibilities. The BEST answer is:
 - A. Mandated reporting
 - B. Malpractice
 - C. Fidelity
 - D. Subpoena response
2. During supervision, Daniel describes an ongoing process in which the client receives understandable information about services, risks, benefits, alternatives, limits of confidentiality and choice. Which concept should guide the discussion?
 - A. Fidelity
 - B. Mandated reporting
 - C. Professional competence
 - D. Informed consent
3. A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by the professional duty to protect information learned in the therapeutic relationship, subject to recognized legal and ethical exceptions. The BEST answer is:
 - A. Termination and referral
 - B. Mandated reporting
 - C. Confidentiality
 - D. Gift decision-making
4. In professional practice, a situation calls for the client's broader right to control access to self, body and personal information. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?
 - A. Dual or multiple relationship
 - B. Ethical response to colleague misconduct
 - C. Privacy
 - D. Justice
5. A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by a legal protection that may prevent compelled disclosure of certain therapy communications in judicial proceedings, depending on jurisdiction. The BEST answer is:
 - A. Subpoena response
 - B. Privileged communication
 - C. Beneficence
 - D. Veracity
6. In professional practice, a situation calls for taking reasonable protective action when a client presents a serious, credible threat toward an identifiable person, as required by applicable law and ethics. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?
 - A. Record keeping
 - B. Duty to warn/protect
 - C. Boundary crossing
 - D. Fidelity
7. In professional practice, a situation calls for reporting suspected abuse or other legally reportable situations to designated authorities when law or professional duty requires it. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?
 - A. Mandated reporting
 - B. Sexual relationship with a current client
 - C. Privacy
 - D. Professional competence

- 8.** During supervision, Owen describes professional negligence in which a duty is breached and the breach causes harm. Which concept should guide the discussion?
- A. Malpractice
 - B. Justice
 - C. Gift decision-making
 - D. Confidentiality
- 9.** A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by practicing only within areas supported by appropriate education, training, supervised experience and current skill. The BEST answer is:
- A. Professional competence
 - B. Confidentiality
 - C. Veracity
 - D. Gift decision-making
- 10.** In professional practice, a situation calls for a situation in which the therapist has another significant role or relationship with the client in addition to therapy. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?
- A. Gift decision-making
 - B. Dual or multiple relationship
 - C. Duty to warn/protect
 - D. Professional competence
- 11.** In professional practice, a situation calls for a departure from customary therapeutic boundaries that may be clinically appropriate and non-exploitative in context. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?
- A. Veracity
 - B. Ethical response to colleague misconduct
 - C. Boundary crossing
 - D. Professional competence
- 12.** During supervision, Wendy describes a serious harmful or exploitative breach of therapeutic boundaries. Which concept should guide the discussion?
- A. Termination and referral
 - B. Beneficence
 - C. Dual or multiple relationship
 - D. Boundary violation
- 13.** A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by sexual or romantic involvement with a current therapy client. The BEST answer is:
- A. Sexual relationship with a current client
 - B. Boundary violation
 - C. Autonomy
 - D. Subpoena response
- 14.** A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by considering clinical meaning, value, timing, culture, power and exploitation risk before accepting or declining a client gift. The BEST answer is:
- A. Termination and referral
 - B. Boundary crossing
 - C. Gift decision-making
 - D. Nonmaleficence
- 15.** A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by accepting goods or services instead of money when ethically permissible, not exploitative and not clinically contraindicated. The BEST answer is:
- A. Subpoena response
 - B. Bartering

C. Beneficence

D. Ethical response to colleague misconduct

SECTION B: ANSWER THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS CORRECTLY (5mks)

1. What is the principle of justice? **(2mks)**
2. What does duty to warn/protect mean in therapy? **(1mks)**
3. Define mandated reporting. **(1mks)**
4. State two ways a therapist should manage sexual or romantic feelings toward a client. **(1mks)**

SECTION C: SHORT ESSAY (5mks)

1. What should a therapist do when credible serious unethical behavior by a colleague is suspected? **(2mks)**
2. Differentiate privacy from confidentiality. **(2mks)**
3. Differentiate confidentiality from privileged communication. **(1mks)**

PART FOUR: CULTURAL DIVERSITY / GROUP THERAPY / COUNSELING PROCESS / TREATMENT PLAN IN PSYCHOTHERAPY

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions: Place a bold tick against the appropriate response option provided. (15mks)

1. In counseling practice, Patricia encounters a situation involving judging other cultures primarily by the standards of one's own culture and treating one's own as the norm. Which concept BEST applies?

- A. Norming stage
- B. Active listening
- C. Progress review
- D. Ethnocentrism

2. In counseling practice, Martha encounters a situation involving pressuring a client to adopt the therapist's or dominant culture's beliefs, values or practices. Which concept BEST applies?

- A. Paraphrasing
- B. Cultural imposition
- C. Rapport building
- D. Skills-development group

3. A trainee observes using a qualified interpreter rather than relying on a child or untrained friend when language barriers affect care. This is an example of:

- A. Professional interpreter use
- B. Cultural imposition
- C. Support group
- D. Paraphrasing

4. A trainee observes a group emphasizing mutual support, shared experience, acceptance and coping among people facing similar problems. This is an example of:

- A. Self-disclosure
- B. Case formulation
- C. Support group
- D. Reflection of feeling

5. In counseling practice, Nadine encounters a situation involving a structured group focused on teaching information, understanding a condition and coping knowledge. Which concept BEST applies?

- A. Ethnocentrism
- B. Goal setting
- C. Therapeutic confrontation
- D. Psychoeducational group

6. Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: a group focused on learning and practicing specific behavioral or interpersonal skills?

- A. Group confidentiality
- B. Treatment plan
- C. Skills-development group
- D. Cognitive-behavioral group

7. Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: a structured group using cognitive and behavioral methods such as thought monitoring, skills practice and behavioral exercises?

- A. Treatment plan
- B. Progress review
- C. Psychoeducational group
- D. Cognitive-behavioral group

- 8.** A trainee observes a recurrent functional position adopted by a member, such as scapegoat, monopolizer, peacemaker or spokesperson. This is an example of:
- A. Skills-development group
 - B. Therapeutic confrontation
 - C. Group role
 - D. Progress review
- 9.** A trainee observes an agreement that members protect information disclosed by other members, while the leader explains that peer confidentiality cannot be guaranteed in the same way as professional confidentiality. This is an example of:
- A. Cultural imposition
 - B. Professional interpreter use
 - C. Group confidentiality
 - D. Storming stage
- 10.** Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: early group stage characterized by orientation, uncertainty, dependence and testing?
- A. Skills-development group
 - B. Case formulation
 - C. Termination and follow-up
 - D. Forming stage
- 11.** A trainee observes group stage in which conflict, resistance, competition or emotional testing becomes more visible. This is an example of:
- A. Storming stage
 - B. Treatment plan
 - C. Norming stage
 - D. Group role
- 12.** A trainee observes group stage in which cohesion, trust, norms and cooperation consolidate. This is an example of:
- A. Termination and follow-up
 - B. Norming stage
 - C. Treatment plan
 - D. Progress review
- 13.** Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: mature working stage in which members use the group productively toward goals?
- A. Open-ended questioning
 - B. Performing stage
 - C. Adjourning stage
 - D. Cultural competence
- 14.** Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: ending stage involving review, separation, consolidation and transfer of learning?
- A. Adjourning stage
 - B. Norming stage
 - C. Intervention stage
 - D. Progress review
- 15.** Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: creating safety, trust, empathy and collaborative engagement at the beginning of counseling?
- A. Active listening
 - B. Therapeutic confrontation
 - C. Assessment

D. Rapport building

SECTION B: SHORT ESSAY (10mks)

1. Differentiate paraphrasing from reflection of feeling. **(4mks)**
2. Why should a qualified interpreter be preferred to a child family member? **(4mks)**
3. State four tasks of ethical termination. **(2mks)**

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SIMULATION OF REAL WORKING SITUATION PAPER PRACTICE SET 03

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SECTION I

1. Trauma symptoms and stabilization

After a violent incident, Nora, 39, experiences nightmares, intrusive memories, avoidance, hypervigilance and episodes of feeling detached or unreal. she becomes overwhelmed when asked to describe the event in detail.

Formulate the presentation and demonstrate an appropriate early trauma-focused session, explaining why pacing matters. (25mks)

2. Adolescent substance use

Patrick, age 16, has begun using pills and alcohol several times a week after being bullied and reports skipping school. The adolescent says, "It is the only thing that calms me down," and is unsure about stopping.

Conduct an initial intervention. Include risk assessment, confidentiality limits, motivation and referral/treatment planning. (25mks)

SECTION II

1. Psychosis and supportive psychotherapy

Lilian, 53, has a history of psychosis and recently began sleeping very little, withdrawing from family and saying that neighbors are sending coded messages through the radio. she is suspicious but willing to talk.

Show how you would conduct a safe supportive session and coordinate care. (25mks)

2. Eating disorder assessment

Benoit, 60, has lost substantial weight, restricts food, fears weight gain and exercises excessively. Family members report dizziness and fainting. Benoit insists there is no problem.

Identify the likely disorder and outline a safe psychotherapy assessment and treatment approach. (25mks)